

Further Listening Unit 5 P 76

Conversation:

1 Why does the man look upset?

- A He isn't satisfied with his team.
- B He has too much work to complete.
- C He has met someone he doesn't like.
- D He is afraid of his demanding manager.

2 How does the woman say she can help the man?

- A She can get more people to work on his team.
- B She can join his team to work for him herself.
- C She can help him do his work in her free time.
- D She can get his manager to reduce his workload.

3 What advice does the woman give to the man?

- A He should learn to deal with pressure.
- B He should have confidence in himself.
- C He should feel free to ask others for help.
- D He should accept more people into his team.

4 Why is the restaurant called 365?

- A It serves 365 different dishes.
- B It is open for business every day.
- C It is located at No. 365 on Sixth Street.
- D It offers seasonal foods all year round.

Scripts:

W: Hey, John! Everything's OK? You look upset.

M: Oh, hi Kate. I was in the cafeteria eating alone. James from accounting walked by, sat down to eat at the table right next to me – didn't say a single word to me. I wondered why.

W: Is that the main thing stressing you out, John?

M: No, I was silly to feel bad about that. What I am stressed about is my workload. My manager, Steven, is a great guy. He always counts on me to get the work done. But I have five meetings this week and two big projects to complete by next Monday. I don't see how I can finish. I'm really worried I'll let my team down.

W: I have some free time on Friday and over the weekend. I can help you with your extra work if you'd like. I know that feeling of being overwhelmed with work. It's awful. I'd like to help.

M: Really? You'd do that for me?

W: Of course I will! John, a lot of us really admire your work. Some of us have asked to work on your team. You're a great example to us, John. You shouldn't doubt yourself. I'm glad to help out.

M: Wow, Kate. Thanks!

W: We could ... discuss it over dinner on Thursday. My treat!

M: Wow. No ... I mean I get to buy dinner, Kate! How about the new restaurant on Sixth Street, 365? It's called 365 because it offers local, seasonal foods – fall, winter, spring, and summer – healthy choices with wonderful fresh fruits and vegetables. Let's meet at 7 p.m.

W: Sounds wonderful! I've heard great things about 365, and I'm excited to try it out.

M: Sure, you'll love it, Kate. And thank you again for offering to help. You are such an awesome colleague and friend.

W: No problem, John. We all need a little help every now and then. So, see you on Thursday, at 7 p.m.

Passage:

1 What prediction is made by the global organization mentioned in the passage?

A Type II diabetes will become the most common kind of disease.

B Diabetes rates among children and young people will be increasing.

C The issue of being overweight can hardly be solved in many countries.

D Over half of the world's population could be overweight or obese by 2035.

2 What are considered the primary causes of the growing issue of being overweight or obese?

A Genetic factors and the increase in age.

B Increased risks of disease and stress in life.

C High-calorie foods and insufficient exercise.

D High blood sugar and poor body composition.

3 Compared to men who were just overweight, how much higher is the risk of diabetes for men who were obese, according to one study?

A Three times higher.

B Four times higher.

C Five and a half times higher.

D Three and a half times higher.

4 What is the primary purpose of the passage?

A To give suggestions on how to maintain a healthy body weight.

B To present statistics on the global issue of overweight and obesity.

C To explain the link between weight and the risk of diabetes in older adults.

D To report how researchers studied the risk of diabetes in older people.

Scripts:

In recent years, doctors have focused on the growing rate of diabetes among children and young people. However, the most common kind of diabetes, type II, is more prevalent as people grow older and gain more weight. The statistics are alarming enough to make people want to stop eating immediately.

According to a recent report from a global organization focused on obesity, 51 percent, or over four billion people, could be overweight or obese by 2035.

Being overweight or obese is a growing problem in many countries. Food high in fat and sugar and a lack of physical activities are considered the primary causes of this global health issue.

A team of researchers studied how body composition—specifically the ratio of lean tissue to fat—and increased weight affected the risk of diabetes in more than 4,000 adults, aged 65 and older.

At the beginning of the study, none of the participants had been diagnosed with diabetes. The researchers tried to assess the relationship between being overweight or obese and the development of the disease through tracking their body mass index.

According to the researchers, even among adults over the age of 75, having a higher body mass index was still associated with a considerably higher risk of diabetes. Men who were obese had a risk of diabetes that was five and a half times higher than those who were just overweight. For women, the risk was about three and a half times higher.

As hard as it might be, making sure your weight stays at a healthy level is the best way to keep the risk of diabetes down. The results of the research affirm the importance of weight control during the middle and later stages of life in terms of reducing the risk of diabetes.

Lectures:

Lecture 1

1 What did the researchers of the new study find about the meaning of happiness?

- A It varies depending on geographical contexts.
- B It is influenced by a self-centered worldview.
- C It can be strongly affected by people's lifestyles.
- D It is primarily determined by personal success.

2 How have Eastern ideologies influenced the concept of happiness in East Asian cultures?

- A Happiness is conditional and varies from person to person.
- B Happiness is a process that connects everyone and everything.
- C Happiness is closely linked to the quality of social relationships.
- D Happiness is defined by one's adherence to traditional values.

3 In which countries did the happiness scale that emphasized independence prove to be most reliable according to the study?

- A In Asian countries.
- B In African countries.
- C In Central American countries.
- D In Western European countries.

4 What does the speaker intend to discuss in the lecture?

- A The measurements of happiness across different countries.
- B The influence of cultural values on the concept of happiness.
- C The difference between the Western and Eastern happiness scales.
- D The potential negative effects of a universal standard of happiness.

Scripts:

What is happiness? This is a question that has intrigued philosophers, psychologists, and individuals around the world for centuries. In a new study from the University of California, Riverside, researchers analyzed how people define and measure happiness across 63 different countries. The experts found that the meaning of happiness varies depending on where people live.

Previously, studies about happiness had mostly focused on the Western world. Consequently, the predominant concept of happiness has been shaped by a self-centered worldview that emphasizes personal worthiness and self-gratification, and sees happiness primarily as personal success.

However, this concept is not universal. According to the new study, while happiness is tied to independence in the West, Eastern happiness is closely related to interdependence.

The East Asian worldview has been described as one in which the self is more closely intertwined with others. As a result, personal happiness often depends on the quality of connections within social relationships. This is evident in Eastern ideologies such as Buddhism, Taoism, and Confucianism, which emphasize the interconnectedness of everyone and everything, and prioritize harmony and balance over individual success. A good example of this is the tendency for people in East Asian countries to frequently associate “happiness” with “family”.

This led the researchers to the new study to determine which tests of happiness would be most effective among 15,368 participants from 63 countries all over the world, including North and Central America, Europe, East and Southeast Asia, and Africa.

The study was focused on two happiness scales. One was developed in the United States, and the other in Japan. The volunteers were surveyed online in 42 different languages.

The Western scale, which highlighted independence, proved to be most reliable for measuring happiness among people in Western European countries, including Belgium, Denmark, and the United Kingdom. However, the scale was not as effective at determining happiness in Eastern countries such as China, Japan, and Vietnam. It also performed poorly in African countries.

The Eastern scale, which stressed interdependence, was found to be most reliable in Asian countries, including China, the Republic of Korea, and Japan. The study showed that this interdependent measure of happiness did not vary nearly as much across countries as the independent measure.

Based on this research, researchers concluded that the meaning of happiness can be influenced significantly by geographical contexts. The finding suggests that it is important for us to avoid imposing a universal standard of happiness, but instead, embrace the diversity of values existing among different cultures and communities.

Lecture 2:

1 How do we typically set conditions for our happiness according to the speaker?

- A By constantly changing our life goals.
- B By waiting for the perfect time to be happy.
- C By setting small goals for our everyday life.
- D By comparing our conditions to those of others.

2 Why does the speaker mention the study conducted by Harvard University?

- A To argue that happiness can be affected by various factors.
- B To provide a historical context for the science of happiness.

- C To support the view that happiness is significant to well-being.
- D To promote the idea that happiness is a pleasant emotional state.

3 Why do some people fail to recognize happiness in everyday life?

- A They neglect to appreciate the small pleasures in life.
- B They lack meaningful connections with people around them.
- C They focus too much on what they have experienced in the past.
- D They don't know what responsibilities to take to achieve happiness.

4 What does the speaker aim to convey about happiness?

- A Happiness is the key to leading a fulfilling and meaningful life.
- B Happiness may not be a natural consequence of adult responsibilities.
- C Happiness can be genuinely achieved after one realizes their goals in life.
- D Happiness is a choice that can be made despite challenging circumstances.

Scripts:

We place a lot of conditions on our happiness. We tell ourselves that we'll be happy when we land our dream job, find love, buy our dream house, travel the world – the list can go on endlessly, and we can spend our lives waiting for the perfect conditions for our happiness.

But the reality is that happiness is not about having, achieving, acquiring, or arriving. Happiness is a choice. We can choose to be happy by seeing the good amongst the challenges.

Happiness is often defined as a pleasant emotional state characterized by feelings of joy and satisfaction. But happiness is more than just a positive state of mind. It also brings physiological benefits such as a longer life span and a stronger, more resilient and robust immune system. Happiness also makes us more likable and helps us to enjoy greater satisfaction in life. A longitudinal study to examine what makes people happy and healthy initiated by Harvard University in the 1930s determined that the high level of happiness in one's daily life was a huge factor in good health and longevity.

However, some of us can fail to recognize happiness as an integral part of everyday life. When we were children, we lived in the moment, fully alive and awake in the present. But as we grow older, we take on more roles and responsibilities. We may gradually lose the ability to engage with and find joy in the small pleasures of life.

By the time we reach adulthood, we have gotten used to working and striving to build the life we desire. Being exhausted at the end of each day can become a way of life. Hence, most of us tend to postpone our happiness.

But happiness postponed can be happiness lost, and life can become a series of missed opportunities. If we focus on what we are lacking, we'll be like passengers on an aircraft, waiting for happiness to touch down.

So, it is essential that we realize life takes place in the present. If we think too much about the past or wonder too much about the future, we can easily distract ourselves from what is really important today. Only in the present can we interact with others, seize new opportunities, and make choices that will positively impact our lives. We do not need to wait for our ideal life to be happy. Happiness is something we can have every day, starting right here and right now.

Keys:

Conversation: B C B D

Passage: D C C C

Lecture 1: A C D B

Lecture 2: B C A D